MY ENGLISH TOOLKIT

Mix & Match Conditionals

Flip the top. Flip the bottom. Make a new sentence!

If... — the top half: the condition

...result. — the bottom half: what happens

Zero
Always true
If + V1 → V1

First
Real future
If + V1 → will + V1

Second
Imagine now
If + V2 → would + V1

Third
Imagine the past
If + had + V3 → would have + V3

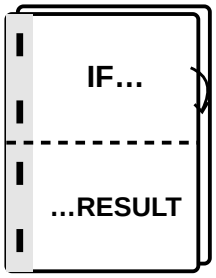
Name: _____

My silliest mix (it must be correct!):

_____

_____

_____



1. **Cut** every sheet down the middle. Sheets 2–5: cut **across** the middle too.
2. **Stack:** this cover, then pages 1 to 8, then the back page. Tops on tops, bottoms on bottoms.
3. **Line up** the left edges. **Staple** 4 times in the gray strip.
4. **Draw** a picture on every half. Write your own sentences on pages 2, 4, 6, and 8.

✂ cut

The 4 conditionals

Zero · Always true — REAL

If + V1 , **V1**

If I **drink** coffee at night, I **don't sleep** well.

First · Real future — REAL

If + V1 , **will + V1**

If it **rains** tomorrow, I **will take** the bus.

Second · Imagine now — NOT REAL

If + V2 , **would + V1**

If I **won** the lottery, I **would buy** a house.

Third · Imagine the past — NOT REAL

If + had + V3 , **would have + V3**

If I **had left** home earlier, I **would have caught** the bus.

How to play

1. **Mix it.** Flip some top halves and some bottom halves. Read your new sentence out loud.
2. **Check it.** Same color? Say it to a partner. Different colors? **The top is the boss.** Change the bottom verb so it matches.
   ~~**If I won the lottery, I will take the bus.**~~ → If I won the lottery, I **would take** the bus.
3. **Cover it.** Cover the bottom half with your hand. Your partner reads the top and finishes the sentence.
4. **Ask it.** What do you do if...? · What will you do if...? · What would you do if...? · What would you have done if...?

Secret! Zero top + First bottom can be correct. Both tops use **If + V1**.
If I drink coffee at night, I will take the bus. ✓ (silly, but correct!)
Comma: If is first? Use a comma. If it rains**,** I take the bus.

ZERO · Always true **REAL**

IF…

If I **drink** coffee at night,

If + V1

It happens **every time**. Facts, habits, and rules.

Draw it!

1 top

✂ cut

ZERO · Always true **REAL**

IF…

If _____ _____

If + V1

Draw it!

Ideas: If I'm tired · If it's cold · If I don't eat breakfast…

2 top

✂ cut across

ZERO · Always true **REAL**

…RESULT

I **don't sleep** well.

V1

Ask a partner: What do you do if…?

Draw it!

1 bottom

ZERO · Always true **REAL**

…RESULT

I _____ _____

V1

Draw it!

Watch out! Both verbs are V1. he / she / it + V1-s: If my son **gets** sick, I **stay** home.

2 bottom

FIRST · Real future REAL

IF…

If it **rains** tomorrow,

If + V1

It **can really happen**. A plan, a promise, a warning.

Draw it!

3 top

✂ cut

FIRST · Real future REAL

IF…

If _____ _____

If + V1

Draw it!

Ideas: If it's sunny this weekend · If I get paid on Friday…

4 top

✂ cut across

FIRST · Real future REAL

…RESULT

I **will take** the bus.

will + V1

Ask a partner: What will you do if…?

Draw it!

3 bottom

FIRST · Real future REAL

…RESULT

I **will** _____ _____

will + V1

Draw it!

Watch out! No **will** after if: ~~If it will rain~~ → If it **rains**

4 bottom

SECOND · Imagine now **NOT REAL**

IF…

If I **won** the lottery,

If + V2

Not real. A dream or a wish. It probably won't happen.

Draw it!

5 top

✂ cut

6 top

SECOND · Imagine now **NOT REAL**

IF…

If

_____

_____

If + V2

Draw it!

Ideas: If I had more time · If I lived near the beach · If I were the boss…

✂ cut across

SECOND · Imagine now **NOT REAL**

…RESULT

I **would buy** a house.

would + V1

Ask a partner: What would you do if…?

Draw it!

5 bottom

6 bottom

SECOND · Imagine now **NOT REAL**

…RESULT

I would

_____

_____

would + V1

Draw it!

Watch out! No **would** after if: ~~If I would have a car~~ → If I **had** a car

THIRD · Imagine the past **NOT REAL**

IF…

If I **had left** home earlier,

If + had + V3

It **did not happen**. It's too late to change it.

Draw it!

7 top

8 top

✂ cut

THIRD · Imagine the past **NOT REAL**

IF…

If

_____

_____

If + had + V3

Draw it!

Ideas: If I had studied more · If I hadn't missed the bus…

✂ cut across

THIRD · Imagine the past **NOT REAL**

…RESULT

I **would have caught** the bus.

would have + V3

Ask a partner: What would you have done if…?

Draw it!

7 bottom

8 bottom

THIRD · Imagine the past **NOT REAL**

…RESULT

I would have

_____

_____

would have + V3

Draw it!

Watch out! had + **V3**, not V2: ~~**If I had went**~~ → If I had **gone**